



MSC Seaside — 4-Night Bahamas

Round-trip from PortMiami

Ship: MSC Seaside · **Sailing from:** MSC Miami Cruise Terminal · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, MSC's quirks, and the cruise rhythm.

Day by day

#	Day	Port	Hours ashore	Dock	The one thing
1	Mon	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart ~5:00 PM	—	All-aboard 4 PM. Sailaway from the Waterfront Boardwalk past Star Island.
2	Tue	Nassau, Bahamas (or) Ocean Cay	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM (<i>Nassau</i>) / ~9:00 AM – late evening (<i>Ocean Cay</i>)	Prince George Wharf (<i>Nassau</i>) / dock alongside (<i>Ocean Cay</i>)	Nassau: skip Bay Street, ride to Cable Beach. Ocean Cay: stay for the late-night lighthouse lighting.
3	Wed	Ocean Cay (or) Nassau	swap of above; verify your sequence	dock alongside	The other of the two.
4	Thu	Ocean Cay overnight (some sailings) OR Cruising at sea	varies — verify	—	If overnight at Ocean Cay: morning swim, late-morning sail. If at sea: pool deck recovery.
5	Fri	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Uber to MIA ~\$30–45. Bayfront Park if killing time.

Itinerary order varies by sailing. Some weeks Nassau is Tuesday, some weeks Wednesday; some weeks Ocean Cay is overnight, some weeks it's a single long day. **Verify in the MSC for Me app before you sail.**

The MSC fare structure (Bella / Fantastica / Aurea / Yacht Club) determines what's included — drink package, Wi-Fi, dining venues, cabin location. **Verify with your booking what's bundled** before assuming.

Currency aboard: USD. **Service Charge (gratuity):** \$14–16/day; verify if pre-paid.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for the Service Charge + cash tips math — MSC mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and on a 4-night cruise you have very few days to break even.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Sunday recommended, Monday required

Sunday — fly in. Same-day flights to a 3:30 PM Monday all-aboard are risky. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach gives you margin and lets you use Sunday for Wynwood Walls, South Beach Art Deco, or Little Havana.

Monday — embarkation.

- **Terminal: MSC Miami Cruise Terminal** at PortMiami (Terminal AA or F — confirm in your booking docs).
- **MIA → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal AA garage **\$35/day** (~\$140/week; firsthand May 2026 — verify). Offsite Miami long-term lots \$7–14/day with shuttle; the offsite math wins for the week if you don’t mind a 15-min Uber to the terminal.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM. **All-aboard 4:00 PM.** Ship departs ~5:00 PM.
- **Online check-in via MSC for Me app** — complete before arrival to skip the queue.

Day 5 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with color-coded tag indicating your debark group.
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at the Marketplace Buffet or Biscayne Bay Buffet.
- **7:00 AM:** Customs clearance complete. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on with you: change of clothes, all medications, passport, phone charger, valuables — anything you can’t lose if a checked bag is misrouted.

Getting from PortMiami to MIA. Uber/Lyft on Friday afternoon, **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes.** Don’t overthink it.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight:

- **Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace** — 10-min walk. Outdoor shopping/dining waterfront.
- **Pérez Art Museum Miami (PAMM)** — 15-min walk. \$20 entry. Air-conditioned.
- **Brickell** — short Uber. Cuban coffee, lunch, then Uber to MIA.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave PortMiami by
Domestic, after 4 PM	1:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:30 PM

MIA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Friday-afternoon cruise return.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — Seaside spots worth knowing

- **The Waterfront Boardwalk** — outdoor promenade circling the ship at sea level. Bars, restaurants, real ocean spray. Sailaway venue and the right place for a sundowner on sea days.
- **The Bridge of Sighs** — glass-floor walkway connecting the two halves of the upper deck, suspended over the ship side. Look down through your feet to the ocean ~16 decks below. Not for the squeamish.
- **MSC Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day intro rates appear; ~90 minutes is the right dose.
- **The Jungle Pool** — central pool deck with retractable roof; the right call on rainy sea days.
- **Garage Club** — late-night dance venue if that's your speed.
- **MSC Yacht Club** (private suite enclave) — if you booked YC, the private deck, private pool, private restaurant Top Sail Lounge, and butler service are the whole point. Use them.

Sea-day priorities (Day 4 if applicable)

1. **Sunrise coffee at the Waterfront Boardwalk aft** — empty in the first hour after dawn.
2. **Thermal suite at the Aurea Spa** — sea-day mornings, intro rate, ~90 minutes.
3. **Specialty lunch** — Butcher's Cut steakhouse for a quieter sit-down at lunch than at dinner.
4. **Port talk for tomorrow's destination** — MSC briefings, worth attending first-time.
5. **Pool deck or Bridge of Sighs photo** — second half of afternoon, light is best.

Specialty dining picks

- **Butcher's Cut** — steakhouse, the steakhouse-quality MSC meal.
- **Asian Market Kitchen** — sushi + Asian fusion; teppanyaki by request.
- **Ocean Cay restaurant** (the venue, not the cay) — seafood-focused.

Port-day picks

- **Nassau** — skip Bay Street tourist shops; catch a \$3 #10 jitney to Cable Beach for a real day. Or arrange a private boat charter from Bay Street docks (~\$80–150/person for a half-day reef-and-rum tour).
- **Ocean Cay** — beach personality choice: South Beach (busy, has the Beach Shack), Bimini/Pineapple (calmer, west side), Ocean House Beach (longest walk, least crowded). If overnight, **stay for the lighthouse evening show** — that's the trip's signature.

The lighthouse show at Ocean Cay

If your sailing includes an Ocean Cay overnight or late departure, the **lighthouse evening show** runs on Bahamian instrumentation: the 98-foot striped tower lights in red-and-white bands, then blue, then climbing gold; projections climb the cladding; ~15 minutes; free; Lighthouse Bay is the seating area. **The reason to want an overnight call.**

Photo spots worth knowing

- **Sailaway from the Waterfront Boardwalk** — Government Cut, Star Island superyachts, the Miami skyline at golden hour.
- **The Bridge of Sighs** — looking through the glass floor at the ocean below.
- **Nassau Bay Street facades** — colonial pastel architecture, especially the Senate House.
- **Ocean Cay striped lighthouse** at golden hour — Lighthouse Bay beach has the angle.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc — ask your host or download from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.